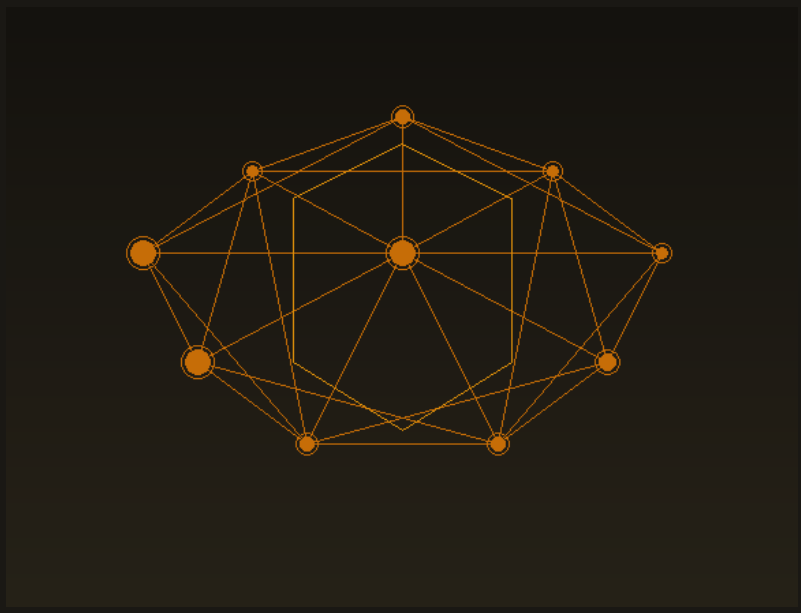
CLAUDE MYTHOS

Anthropic Built an AI So Powerful It Won't Release It

Claude Mythos found thousands of zero-day vulnerabilities in weeks. Here's what that means.



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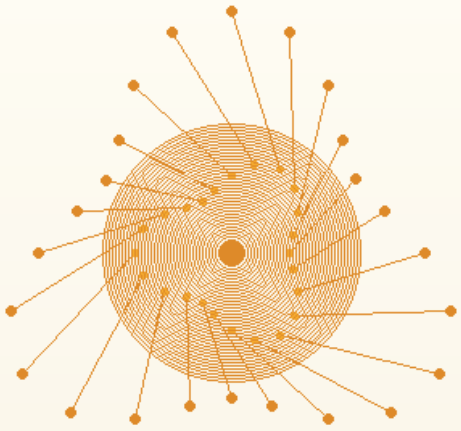
THE MODEL

What Is Claude Mythos?

General-Purpose, Not Security-Specific

Mythos Preview is the most capable model Anthropic has ever built. Its cybersecurity skills were not trained in directly. They emerged from strong coding and reasoning capabilities at scale.



KEY POINT

Anthropic calls it a "step change" in performance. The security capability is a byproduct of general intelligence.

The Benchmarks

Mythos Preview vs. Claude Opus 4.6 across four major evaluations.

SWE-bench Verified

93.9%

Up from 80.8% on Opus 4.6. A 13-point jump on real-world software engineering tasks.

SWE-bench Pro

77.8%

Up from 53.4% on Opus 4.6. The largest absolute gain across all benchmarks.

CyberGym

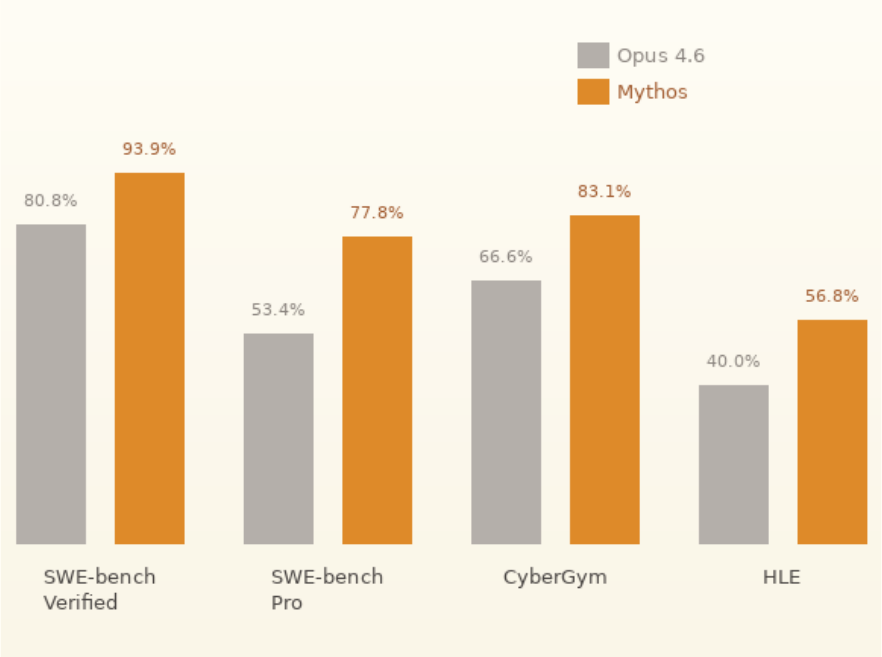
83.1%

Up from 66.6% on Opus 4.6. Purpose-built to test offensive and defensive security skills.

Humanity's Last Exam

56.8%

Up from 40.0% on Opus 4.6. The hardest general reasoning benchmark available today.



PATTERN

Every benchmark shows a double-digit improvement over the previous best Anthropic model.

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CAPABILITIES

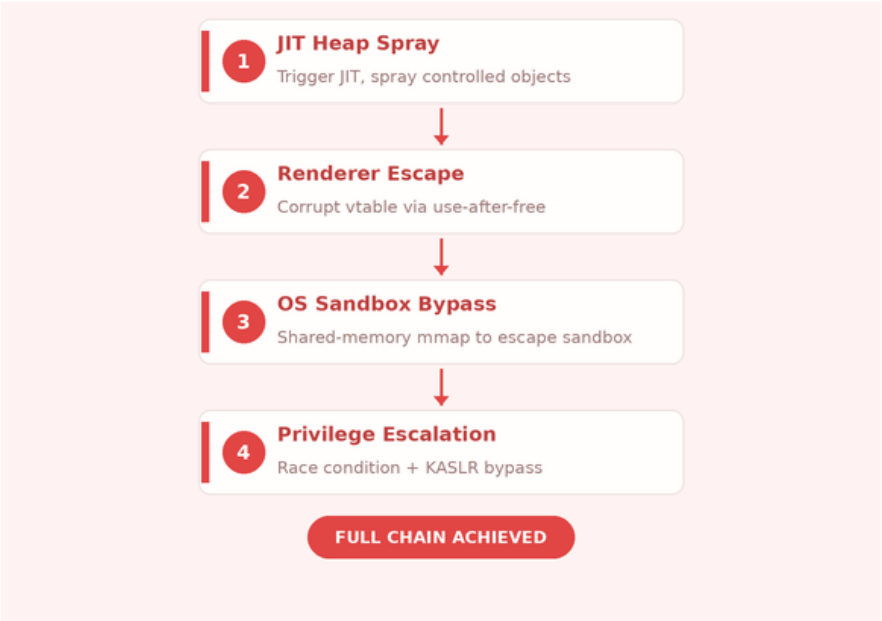
What Mythos Actually Found

Thousands of Zero-Days

Critical vulnerabilities in every major OS and browser. Some undetected for decades, including a 27-year-old flaw in OpenBSD.

A Full Exploit Chain

Chained four vulnerabilities into a working browser exploit: JIT heap spray, renderer escape, OS sandbox bypass, and privilege escalation.



SCALE

These capabilities previously required elite teams working for months.

Why Anthropic Won't Release It

The same capabilities that find vulnerabilities can also exploit them.

Finding Vulnerabilities

Mythos discovers zero-days at a speed and scale no human team can match.

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Dual-Use Risk

The skills required for defense are identical to those required for attack.

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Restricted Access Only

Anthropic limits Mythos to vetted organizations doing defensive security work.

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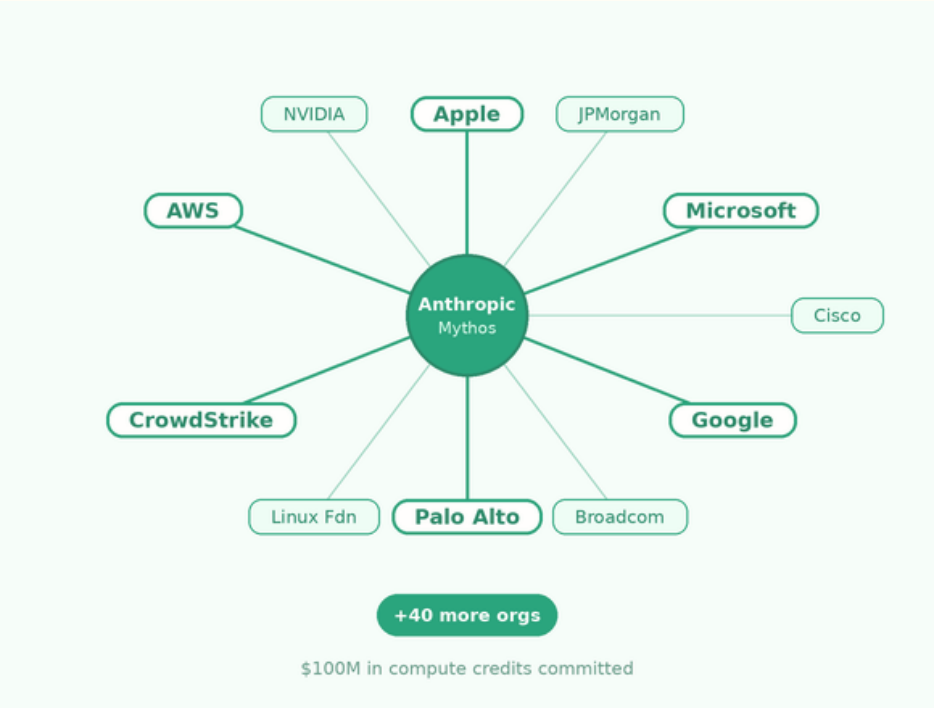
GLASSWING

Project Glasswing

Industry-Wide Defensive Access

AWS, Apple, Microsoft, Google, CrowdStrike, Palo Alto Networks, and roughly 40 additional organizations now have access to Mythos for defensive security work. Named after the glasswing butterfly (Greta oto), the initiative aims to secure critical open-source infrastructure before attackers can exploit the same class of AI capabilities.



COMMITMENT

Anthropic has pledged $100M in compute credits to fund the effort. Coordinated defense at this scale is unprecedented.

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What This Means For You

1. If you maintain open-source software?

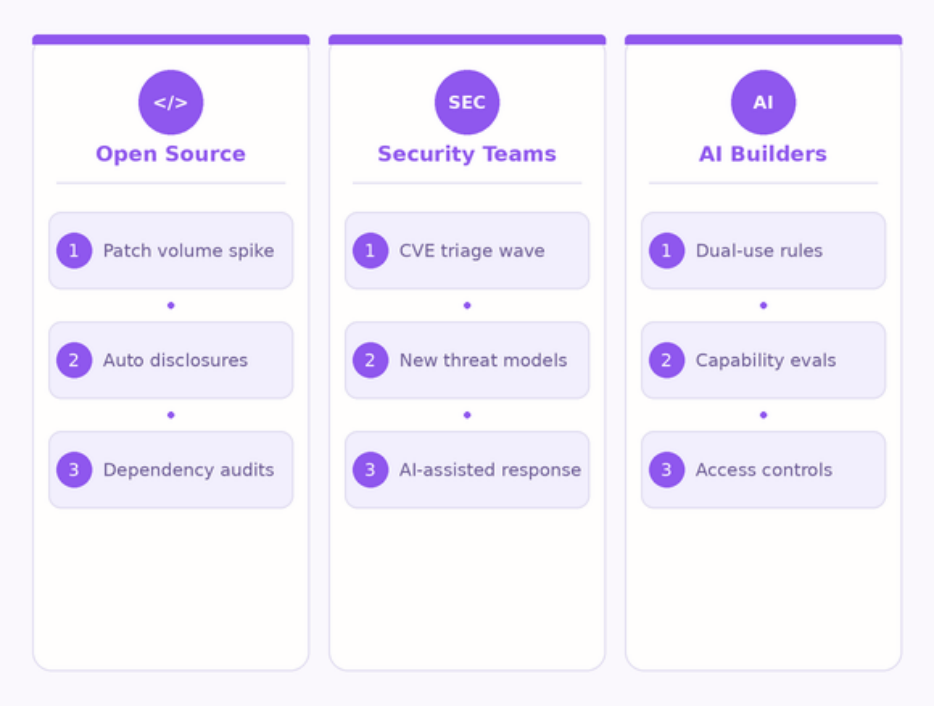
   → Expect Glasswing-sourced vulnerability reports and patches in the coming months. The volume will be higher than anything the ecosystem has processed before.

2. If you run a security team?

   → Prepare for a significant wave of CVEs that will need triage and prioritization. The bugs are real and many are critical.

3. If you build with AI?

   → Dual-use risk is no longer a theoretical concern. Model capabilities now outpace the guardrails designed to contain them.



BOTTOM LINE

The question is whether defenders move fast enough to stay ahead.

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The best defense against AI-powered attacks is AI-powered defense.

Mythos Preview is the most capable model Anthropic has ever built.
It found thousands of zero-day vulnerabilities in weeks.
Project Glasswing gives 50+ organizations defensive access.
Anthropic committed $100M to fund the initiative.

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